

Chapter 97-4

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Liang Shi and Shen Hui both spent the night at the police station, along with the victim.

After the three of them went in to give their statements, Liang Shi explained her "criminal process" with clear logic and a cooperative attitude. The police officers were quite bewildered.

The thing was, her account didn't match the victim's. The victim claimed that Liang Shi had definitely beaten her until she was bruised and such.

Shen Hui's bystander testimony was even more straightforward. Liang Shi had definitely hit her, but she didn't know how hard. She had wanted to intervene, but before she could, Liang Shi had already finished the fight. Her movements were very fast.

Shen Hui said she felt quite helpless about it too.

In the end, they could only do an injury examination. After waiting all night, the results came back as minor injury—not even close to meeting the standard for criminal charges, let alone detention.

For this kind of civil dispute, both sides were encouraged to settle privately.

The officers did ideological work with them all night. Liang Shi was very cooperative and willing to accept any outcome.

The victim was in a daze for a long time. After staying up all night, she finally couldn't hold out anymore and agreed to settle.

So Liang Shi compensated her three thousand yuan and signed a settlement agreement. But she still needed someone to come pick her up and pay the fine.

Liang Shi reasonably suspected that this rule existed just to publicly humiliate her.

At six in the morning, dawn had just broken, and the distant eastern sky was showing the pale light of fish belly white¹.

Liang Shi scrolled through her contacts. She didn't call Xu Qingzhu, but called Liang Xinhe instead. Liang Xinhe didn't answer.

Looking at Shen Hui who was still signing paperwork, Liang Shi called Zhao Xuning directly.

Zhao Xuning, who kept a good sleep schedule, answered immediately, though she still had a hint of morning grumpiness. Her tone was unfriendly. "This better be important."

"Come pick me up at the police station." Liang Shi said. "Your ex-girlfriend is here too."

Zhao Xuning was jolted awake and became even more agitated. "What happened?"

But rustling sounds could already be heard on the other end, like she was getting dressed.

Liang Shi said, "I hit someone....."

"You f***ing hit Shen Hui? Are you crazy?" Zhao Xuning said through gritted teeth. "Just wait....."

Liang Shi: "....."

She suspected Zhao Xuning's next words would be—I'm coming with a knife.

Liang Shi quickly explained, "No, no, how could I hit your beloved ex-girlfriend? Your ex-girlfriend is a witness. She's been at the police station with me all night. I need someone to come pay the fine and take me away."

Zhao Xuning: ".....Where?"

After Liang Shi told her, she stood there waiting. She had only slept a little over two hours the whole night, but she wasn't tired now.

Probably because it was her first time getting into a fight and ending up at the police station—it was quite a novel experience.

All night she had been thinking—She actually had a day like this?

If Sister Wang and her assistant Xiao Bai saw this, they would definitely be overjoyed and praise her for finally toughening up.

Actually, at the time, Liang Shi hadn't thought about the consequences. She was just annoyed by that person.

No matter what, you can't speak so rudely to children.

Before long, Liang Xinhe replied to her message: 【What's up?】

Liang Shi: 【Nothing now. Why are you up so early?】

Liang Xinhe: 【I never went to sleep!】

A few seconds later, a voice message came through. Even through the screen, you could hear his anger. "I'm at the hospital. I'm about to explode. That Liang Xinran, she..... I..... I'm really going to explode from anger!"

Liang Shi: "....."

She didn't want to get involved, but since Liang Xinhe had already said this much, she could only follow up with a question: 【What happened?】

A long voice message from Liang Xinhe came through. Even through the screen, his anger was palpable. "I went home last night to confront them, but Mom just took Liang Xinran's side. I just asked Liang Xinran a few questions—asked her why she wanted to take Ling Dang out, asked her why she apologized on my daughter's behalf when Ling Dang didn't even admit to doing anything wrong. Ling Dang has grown up this big and I've never been willing to lay a finger on her. And then, I just spend a few days at the company, and this is what happens at home. I'm f***ing furious!"

"I didn't even curse at anyone—I just asked her a few questions. And then! She fainted. I'm truly impressed. Didn't she grow up in the countryside? My Ling Dang didn't faint when they were pointing at her nose and scolding her, but she did..... I'm so pissed."

"Liang Shi, let me tell you, I finally understand why Big Brother was so decisive back then. This person coming back is nothing but a disaster. I got hit too! Mom has gone crazy—she's turned against her own family for her. Before, Mom spoiled you, sure, but she never did anything like this for you. Now she's really gone mad. What Sister-in-law said when she left home was absolutely right—she's been bewitched by Liang Xinran!"

Liang Xinhe's voice messages were especially long. He was so angry that his voice was shaking. But Liang Shi managed to piece together a thread from his rage-filled words.

Footnotes:

¹ **Fish belly white (魚肚白):** A Chinese expression describing the pale, grayish-white color of the sky at dawn, resembling the pale underbelly of a fish. It's a common literary way to describe the early morning sky just before sunrise.